

CSEG1 – Game Concepts and Design Lab Activity

[Game Concept]

Group Name: **JAPEN**

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Game Name: SOLVE AGAINST THE ODDS

Genre: CARD, PUZZLE, STRATEGY

Settings: Classroom

Story: Two rivals step into a classroom filled with puzzles. They battle through Rock, Paper, Scissors to earn the right to solve each puzzle, while the loser can use a lucky coin flip to turn the tables. As the competition continues, wild cards disrupt their plans and luck constantly changes the course of the game. With 10 puzzles waiting to be solved, every point becomes important. In the end, the rival who earns the most points becomes the champion.

Gameplay:

Two players compete in a classroom puzzle competition consisting of 10 puzzles. Each round begins with Rock, Paper, Scissors to determine who gets the chance to solve the puzzle. The loser can flip a coin for a chance to use a Wild Card and disrupt the winner, leading to another round of Rock, Paper, Scissors. If the loser fails the coin flip, the winner gets to solve the puzzle. Each solved puzzle earns a point, and after all 10 puzzles are completed, the player with the most points wins.

[Formal Elements]

Players:

Two-player game.

Objectives:

To successfully solve the most puzzles out of the 10 available puzzles to win the match.

Rules:

- #1 A turn consists of both players selecting a card (Rock, Paper, or Scissors) to determine who gets the right to solve a puzzle.
- #2 The player who loses the Rock-Paper-Scissors clash may invoke a "Rebuttal" by flipping a coin.
- #3 If the coin flip lands on Heads, the rebuttal succeeds, overriding the previous turn result and forcing both players to repeat the Rock-Paper-Scissors selection.
- #4 If the coin flip lands on Tails, the rebuttal fails and remains invalid; the winner of the original Rock-Paper-Scissors match proceeds directly to puzzle-solving.

#5 The player who earns the rights to the puzzle must complete/solve it to claim a point.

Procedures:

- #1. Layout the 10 puzzle cards and prepare the Rock, Paper, Scissors cards alongside the coin.
- #2. Both players simultaneously pick and reveal a card.
- #3. Determine the initial winner based on standard Rock-Paper-Scissors mechanics.
- #4 The losing player decides whether to trigger a rebuttal coin flip.
- #5. If heads, both players will simultaneously pick and reveal a card again, if Tails the winning player attempts to solve the available puzzle.
- #6 If solved, mark the puzzle as completed by that player. Repeat the cycle until all 10 puzzles are resolved.

Resources:

A set of Rock, Paper, and Scissors Cards, 10 puzzle challenges, 1 coin, and a score tracking sheet.

Conflicts:

Strategic card selection against the opponent, managing the risk/reward of triggering coin-flip rebuttals, and time or accuracy pressure while solving puzzles.

Boundaries:

- #1 - 10 fixed puzzles on the board
- #2 - Rock, Paper, Scissors win conditions
- #3 - Binary (Heads/Tails) rebuttal rules

Outcomes: Zero-sum outcome where the player with the highest tally of solved puzzles wins the game. Ties occur if both players solve an equal number (5-5).

[Game Atoms]

- Coin Flip → Coin Flip Won → Draw Wild Card
- Draw Wild Card → Activate Wild Card → Affect Opponent

[Game Loop]

- Pick a Card (Rock, Paper, or Scissors) → Coin Flip Rebuttal → Winner Solves The Puzzle → Gain Points

[Critical Analysis]

- **Why is this game enjoyable?** - The game is enjoyable because players can compete against each other while solving puzzles. The combination of Rock-Paper-Scissors, the coin-flip rebuttal, and puzzle solving makes every turn exciting and unpredictable.
- **What mechanics make it fun?** The Rock-Paper-Scissors mechanic makes players think about which card to choose, while the coin-flip rebuttal gives the losing player another chance.

The puzzle-solving mechanic also adds a challenge and rewards players for solving puzzles correctly.

- **Is the game balanced?** - Yes, the game is balanced because both players have the same cards, the same opportunities to win puzzles, and access to the same rebuttal mechanic. Although the coin flip adds luck, both players have an equal chance of getting Heads or Tails.
- **Are the objectives clear?** - Yes, the objectives are clear because players can easily understand what they need to do to win the game.
- **Is the difficulty appropriate?** - Yes, because the game is challenging enough to keep players interested, but it is not too hard to understand or play.
- **What improvements could be made?** - The game could be improved by adding more challenges and making each level a little different.

[Game Design]

